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Around six months ago, when Damir Dzumhur entered Court Philippe-Chatrier for his third-round match at Roland Garros, not many gave him a chance. After all, the 33-year-old Bosnian was up against defending champion Carlos Alcaraz, who was in red-hot form. As expected, the 22-year-old Spaniard quickly took a 6-1, 6-3 lead. The Parisian crowd, perhaps out of hope to get its money's worth for a night session, started to get behind Dzumhur.

When Dzumhur trailed 2-3 in the third set, the writing seemed to be on the wall. But the Bosnian was not done yet. Shortly after a medical timeout to receive treatment for his groin, Dzumhur turned the tide. He started playing more aggressively, matching the rattled Spaniard shot for shot and grabbed the third set 6-4. Then he pulled ahead 3-1 in the fourth before Alcaraz found his touch again to clinch the fourth set 6-4 and close the fixture.

Facing Alcaraz isn't easy. Challenging him is even more difficult. But for Dzumhur, the Spaniard wasn't the first curveball life had thrown at him. Not even the biggest.

From the moment he came into this world, Dzumhur was surrounded by adversity. In 1992, the Bosnian War had begun just a month before he was born. "The war had started in Sarajevo. It was very

DZUMHUR'S SECOND WIND

The Bosnian tennis player reflects on his journey from surviving a war to **pushing** Carlos Alcaraz to the brink at Roland Garros.